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Senate of Virginia Floor Session, Friday, January 30, 2026

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[00:00:59] Senate chamber. This is the Senate of Virginia, Richmond, Virginia. Senate chamber.

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[00:05:16] This is the Senate of Virginia, Richmond, Virginia.

[00:06:28] Senate chamber.

[00:08:55] This is the Senate of Virginia, Richmond, Virginia.

[00:09:43] Senate chamber.

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[00:12:06] This is the Senate of Virginia, Richmond, Virginia.

[00:13:40] Senate chamber.

[00:13:42] This is the Senate of Virginia, Richmond, Virginia.

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[00:17:56] This is the Senate of Virginia, Richmond, Virginia, chamber.

[00:20:02] This is the Senate of Virginia, Richmond, Virginia, chamber.

[00:23:44] Be sure to stay connected with live sessions, catch up on past meetings, and explore our full archives anytime on the Senate of Virginia's YouTube channel.

[00:24:48] This is the Senate of Virginia, Richmond, Virginia.

[00:25:22] Senate chamber.

[00:26:48] The Senate will come to order.

[00:27:06] The senators will please take their seats. Those persons not entitled to the privileges of the floor will retire to the gallery. The senators and all in attendance will stand if you are able and be led in prayer today by the Reverend Mike Maton of Bon Air United Methodist Church in Norchester Field.

[00:27:24] And following the prayer, everyone will please remain standing and be led in the Pledge of Allegiance to the flag of the United States of America by Senate page Edwin Cotknapp from Richmond. One of the ideas of wisdom that has come to me this week is that the reality always outweighs the idea.

[00:27:46] The idea would be false if the reality is not genuine, so the reality always supersedes any kind of ideas. From that position, let us pray. Almighty God, give us wisdom, give us courage, give us grace that we might share what you have given to us with all in need. We pray this prayer today as a unified body. Amen and amen.

[00:28:17] I pledge allegiance to the flag of the United States of America, and to the republic, one nation, under God, indivisible, with liberty and justice for all.

[00:28:50] The clerk will call the roll. All those present will please vote aye. The clerk will close the roll.

[00:29:24] You have a quorum, Madam President. Senate Journal for Thursday, January 29, 2026. The senator from Isle of Wight moves that the reading of the journal be waived. All in favor of waiving the reading of the journal will record their vote aye. Those opposed no are the senators ready to vote.

[00:29:42] Have all the senators voted. Do any senators desire to change their vote? The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 36, nose 1. Ayes 36, nose 1. The reading of the journal is waived.

[00:29:59] The clerk will report any communication from the House of Delegates.

[00:30:04] The chair recognizes the senator from Eastern Fairfax. Good morning. Madam President, I move to waive the reading of the communication from the House of Delegates. The question is, shall the reading of the communication be waived? All in favor of waiving the reading of the communication from the House of Delegates will record their votes. Aye. Those opposed, no. Are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted? Do any senators desire to change their vote? The clerk will close the roll.

[00:30:41] the numbers as 30 no seven eyes 30 no seven the reading 30 no seven eyes 30 no seven the reading of the communication is waived the clerk will report any

[00:31:21] communication from the governor I do not have any madam president we've now arrived at the time in the morning hour when we have the honor of welcoming our distinguished guests who are joining us in the gallery I give my daily reminder that a senator will rise and provide an introduction for their visitors and I will then offer the welcome of the Senate. I ask that we all hold applause until I've

completed the Senate's welcome. The chair recognizes the senator from Colonial Heights. Thank you, Madam President. I rise for an introduction. The

[00:32:00] senator has the floor. Madam President, getting us off to a great start today is someone who is no stranger to this body, Pastor Mike Maiden of Bonaire United Methodist Church is joining us today gave us a great prayer recognizing it's an icy Friday he had a wonderful length to that prayer and so on behalf of the senator from Richmond City the chair madam president and myself I'd ask that we offer pastor Mayton the warm welcome of the Senate I thank the senator for that introduction and welcome again to the Reverend Mayton thank you so much

[00:32:38] for braving the roads and joining us. I know you just returned from Florida where it was balmy and sunny and the rude awakening of our frigid temperatures here, but thank you so much for joining us today and offering your prayer. The chair recognizes the senator from Roanoke. Thank you, Madam President. I ask that the journal reflect that the senator from King George is away from the senate today on pressing personal business. The journal will so reflect. Thank you.

[00:33:17] the chair recognizes the senator from um prince edward thank you madam president i'd like to request a leave of absent for my desk mate the senator from mecklenburg who's away on pressing personal business the journal will so reflect thank you senator is there any other

[00:33:47] business for the morning hour the chair recognizes the senator from charlottesville madam president uh move that the rules be suspended and that sjr 65 be taken up for immediate consideration the question is shall the rules be suspended and sjr 65 be taken up for immediate consideration all in favor of the motion will record their votes aye those opposed no are the senators ready

[00:34:25] to vote have all the senators voted do any senators desire to change their vote the clerk will close the roll. Ayes 38, noes 0. Ayes 38, noes 0. The rules are suspended to take up the resolution for immediate consideration. The clerk will please read the title. Senate Joint Resolution 65, commending Debbie Ryan. The chair recognizes the senator from Charlottesville. Madam President, I move the resolution be agreed to. The question is, shall the resolution be agreed to? All in

[00:35:04] favor of agreeing to the resolution will say aye those opposed will say aye aye those opposed no the resolution is agreed to the chair again recognizes the senator from charlottesville madam president i rule i move that the rules be suspended and that sjr 67 be taken up for immediate consideration the question is shall the rules be suspended and sjr 67 bs sj 60 r 67 excuse me will be taken up for immediate consideration all in favor of the motion

[00:35:39] will record their votes aye those opposed no are the senators ready to vote have all the senators voted do any senators desire to change their vote the clerk will close the roll eyes 38 no zero eyes 38 no zero the rules are suspended to take up the resolution for immediate consideration the clerk will Please read the title.

[00:36:05] Senate Joint Resolution 67, commending Sweetwater College. The Senator from Charlottesville. Madam President, I move that the resolution be agreed to. The question is, shall the resolution be agreed to? All in favor of agreeing to the resolution will say aye.

[00:36:21] Any opposed, no. The resolution is agreed to. The Chair recognizes the Senator from Eastern Fairfax. Thank you, Madam President. I move that the rules be suspended and that HJR 91 be taken up for immediate consideration.

[00:36:36] The question is, shall the rules be suspended and HJR 91 be taken up for immediate consideration? All in favor of the motion will record their votes, aye. Those opposed, no.

[00:36:52] Are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted? Do any senators desire to change their vote? The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 38, noes 0. Ayes 38, noes 0. The rules are suspended to take up the resolution for immediate consideration.

[00:37:12] The clerk will please read the title. House Joint Resolution 91, Celebrating the Life of Gladys Mae West. All those in favor of agreeing to the memorial resolution, please rise. The resolution is agreed to.

[00:37:49] The chair recognizes the senator from Eastern Fairfax.

[00:38:06] Thank you, Madam President. I rise for a motion. And speaking to them. Senator has the floor. Sorry, I move that we recess for 30 minutes and speak to that motion. The senator has the floor. Thank you.

[00:38:24] Thank you, Madam President. Ladies and gentlemen, we need to have a quick P&E meeting at the chairman's desk today. And then after that, we need to have a quick caucus meeting. And so-- actually, why don't we say 20 minutes? So why don't we say a 20-minute recess?

[00:38:39] Because I know people need to get out of here with the snow and everything. And then after that, we'll be able to get on with the calendar, which shouldn't be too long. Madam President. Would the gentleman yield for a question? The senator from Hanover has the floor.

[00:38:56] I yield. Madam President, I'd ask the senator if he could inform us what action will be taken at the P&E meeting that will be at the desk and not available for public comment. Senator from Eastern Fairfax. We'll be taking up the three bills that place the constitutional amendments, the three constitutional amendments on the ballot in November.

[00:39:18] The Fourth Amendment was already, the language for that was done yesterday through the skinny budget bill. This has to do with the three constitutional amendments that I believe we've already heard that legislation in the Senate, the Senate version in P&E, so it was given a full public hearing in P&E.

[00:39:39] This is just the House cognates that are coming through and that's what we're doing. And they were also read on the floor yesterday, I think you were in the back when we made motion to wave reading and you came out and then you they were actually right on the floor because you all wouldn't wave reads madam president i'd certainly the majority can do what they want to do but i would say these are constitutional amendments these are the ballot questions the public should have at least the ability to be able to speak the fact that it's not been publicized and certainly senate bills came through but as all bills come through people

[00:40:19] would like to have the opportunity to express their views so i don't know what the rush is to do this on a friday afternoon with no public comment but yet again before another snowstorm so i'd ask that at the very least this be a committee meeting open to the public and allowed for them to be able to speak president senator from eastern fairfax speaking to the emotion senator has the floor thank you president up i'll just remind the body that these bills were given a full public hearing previously in the senate public was allowed to come they were also given

[00:40:55] full public hearings in the house as is often the case with identical cognates identical cognates we often don't even allow public testimony in hearing in hearings on identical cognates and uh and so i'm not clear what the big deal is but um i think we take care of this efficiently this morning the clerk will proceed the committee on privileges and elections will meet immediately upon recess

[00:41:29] at the chair's desk the senate will be at recess the senate will come to order the clerk will call

[01:19:52] the calendar senate calendar for friday january 30th 2026 uncontested calendar senate bills on third reading the chair recognizes the senator from prince william madame president i move the senate bills on third read uncustodized calendars page one through eight senate bills 143 senate bill 734 will be placed on the final passage in the block any senator designed to remove the bill from the block may do so after the clerk has read the number of the bill the chair reminds the senior senator from prince william that he is the senior senator from prince william and not

[01:20:31] the senator from eastern henrico eastern fairfax i just love to move him to henrico he just he just needs to move the question is shall the senate bills on the uncontested calendar third reading Pages 1 through 8 Senate bill 140 through Senate bill 734 be placed upon their final passage in the block with the understanding that any senator desiring to remove a bill from the block will do so after the clerk has read the number of the bill all in favor of the motion will say aye

[01:21:06] any opposed no the ayes have it the motion is agreed to the bills are now before us in the block the clerk will read the number of the bill senate bill 140 senate bill 164 senate bill 166 senate bill 172 senate bill 246 senate bill 358 senate bill 403 senate bill 404 senate bill 479

[01:21:36] senate bill 520 senate bill 546 senate bill 591 senate bill 593 senate bill 622 senate bill 626 senate bill 630 senate bill 649 senate bill 734. the question is shall the bills in the block pass all in favor of the passage of the bills will record their votes aye those opposed no are the

[01:22:10] the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted? Do any senators desire to change their vote? The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 38, noes 0. Ayes 38, noes 0. The bills in the block pass.

[01:22:26] Regular calendar, Senate bills on third reading. Senate bill 297, a bill relating to use of photo speed monitoring devices repeal. The chair recognizes the senator from Lynchburg. Thank Thank you, Madam President. By popular demand, I would request that Senate Bill 297 go by for the day.

[01:22:45] Without objection. Senate Bill 306, a bill relating to use of violation monitoring systems to enforce traffic light signals and certain traffic control devices repeal. The Senator from Lynchburg. Yes, Madam President. Similarly, I would request that Senate Bill 306 go by for the day.

[01:23:03] Without objection. Senate Bill 347, a bill relating to local regulation of solar facilities, special exceptions. The chair recognizes the senator from Western, Henrico. Thank you, Madam President. Madam President, I move passage of the bill in speaking to that motion.

[01:23:23] The senator has the floor. Thank you, Madam President. Madam President, members of the body, Senate Bill 347 is about solar siting and energy. This bill does three things and just bear with me for a second so I can explain it and make sure we're all on the same page about what it does.

[01:23:39] The first thing it does is it puts a ban on bans. It says that localities cannot ban solar projects outright. The second thing it does is it creates a series of standards that localities may follow if they would like, which was a response to the idea of how do we ensure that solar developers are on the up and up?

[01:24:02] We ensure that these projects are done well from beginning to end to decommissioning. And the third thing it does is it collects data, the SEC collects data on what happens to these projects and why. This bill does not mandate one solar project.

[01:24:20] As a matter of fact, after this bill goes into effect, every solar project in Virginia can be voted down. The localities have complete discretion over making the choice. What this bill does is it says that they have to take the bills up one by one. And the hope here is that by doing so, we make this conversation a little less ideological.

[01:24:40] We make it a little bit more about the merits of individual projects. We look at what the property owner's requesting. We look at the economics of a project. We see if it makes sense. At the end of the day, the locality still can say no, but that's what this bill does.

[01:24:57] And hopefully we do get a little bit more energy out of it, because we do have energy in the commonwealth and solar is one part of that solution and so having said that madam president i renew my motion that the bill pass the question is shall senate bill 347 pass all in favor of the motion will record their vote aye those opposed no are the senators ready to vote have all the senators voted do any senators desire to change their vote the clerk will close the roll eyes 21

[01:25:33] No 17 eyes 21 no 17 Senate bill 347 passes Senate bill 57 a bill to require the Commonwealth's participation in the electronic registration information center Eric the chair recognizes the senator from Western Henrico thank you madam president madam president I move passage of the bill and speaking to them the senator has the floor thank you madam president madam president this is This is a bill we've seen before so I'll be brief.

[01:26:02] This tells Virginia to rejoin ERIC, a nonpartisan organization that we were a founding member of and so I renew my motion to pass the bill. The question is, shall Senate Bill 57 pass?

[01:26:21] All in favor of the motion will record their votes aye, those opposed no. Are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted? any senators desire to change their votes the clerk will close the roll as 21 no 17 eyes 21 no 17 Senate bill 57 passes Senate bill 226 a bill relating to competitive bidding for compost and other products containing organic soil amendments waste disposal infrastructure civil penalty the chair recognizes the senator from Eastern Fairfax thank you madam president move

[01:27:00] bill passed and speaking to that motion senator has the floor thank you madam president ladies and gentlemen Senate this bill does two things one it gives localities the authority to require large organic waste producers to segregate organic waste from other trash so that it can be used for composting or biomethanization and the second thing it does is it requires any new school construction to require uh it to be built so that it can waste can be segregated in a school schools are some of the largest producers of food waste because our kids don't like to clean their

[01:27:39] plates uh the original idea for this bill came largely in part from governor youngkin's deq who had a organic waste task force that recommended we do more to encourage composting and i was happy to take Governor Yonkin's suggestion and put it in a bill, and then he was happy to veto the bill based on his idea.

[01:28:07] So we've already passed this bill once, I would hope we can pass it again. The question is, the chair recognizes the senator from Rockingham. Madam President, rise to speak to the bill.

[01:28:27] Senator has the floor. This is a garbage bill, first of all. Number two, I lost count of the number of times that the Senator from Eastern Fairfax said the word "require."

[01:28:45] As I recall, and as I heard in the Senator from Eastern Fairfax's comments, the initial recommendation was to encourage. I would join in a piece of legislation to encourage large generators of this waste to to put it to some productive use, maybe in a municipal waste power generator or some such similar use, but the mandatory aspect of this just goes too far in this garbage bill.

[01:29:24] Thank you. Senator from Eastern Fairfax. Thank you Madam President, no one else desires to speak. There is no one else. Okay, speaking to the bill. Senator, how's the floor? First of all, the first part of the bill just gives local governments Dillon rule authority to be able to require, but it doesn't actually require it themselves.

[01:29:47] In the state of Maryland, the state of Maryland actually passed the law requiring separation statewide. This bill doesn't do that. This bill doesn't do that. This bill just gives localities the authority to if they want to. And I believe what the Governor Youngkin, at least in his veto statement, was unhappy about was he thought the penalties, potential penalties were too high or something.

[01:30:06] The only part of the bill that requires anything is the part that requires schools to construct any new school facilities to segregate organic waste. So that's the only actual mandate in the bill. Madam President, I'd ask -- Senator from Rockingham. The Senator from Eastern Fairfax would rise for a question.

[01:30:23] The Senator yields. I would ask the senator from Eastern Fairfax whether this, in a jurisdiction that does choose to mandate this for restaurants or schools, is calculated to make food and restaurants more affordable?

[01:30:45] Senator from Eastern Fairfax. Madam President, this is a Dillon Rule authority bill. I guess the locality could potentially maybe make that part of their ordinance if they chose. I would just note, though, that one of the things that was pointed out to me about in the state of Maryland when they adopted this was that by requiring, in Maryland, they required either you take the waste to a biomethanization facility or you beneficially reuse it, which, in other words, means take it to a food bank.

[01:31:18] And what they found in Maryland was that all their food banks became overwhelmed with food, Overwhelmed so much. In fact, I was at an event in Arlington the other day with some Arlington public service folks and they said that the National Harbor Casino brings excess food from National Harbor to Maryland's food banks every day because in Maryland they can't find enough places to give the food away, which I thought was actually an excellent consequence of this because our food banks are often short on food.

[01:31:48] Senator from Rockingham. Madam President, perhaps I was inartful in my phrasing of the question. My question, the question that I intended to ask was, in a jurisdiction that mandated this with respect to its restaurants, would it make restaurant, shopping in a restaurant or visiting a restaurant more affordable for families living in that jurisdiction or visiting that jurisdiction?

[01:32:18] Senator from Eastern Fairfax, do you yield for that question? I was about to say, I'll yield. Madam President, what I would say is, I'm not sure, but I'm not sure that it actually could make the food waste coming from that restaurant more valuable.

[01:32:39] And the reason I say that is because if you can take that food waste and use it as feedstock for a biomethanization facility that then is used to create methane and sell the methane, actually might make the organic waste have value much like when restaurants sell the grease leftover grease out of their grease skillets for being reused and made into biodiesel it's possible that it actually might not cost the restaurants anything to segregate other than the fact they got to buy another bin so I'm not I'm not sure I haven't looked into the economics of that side of it madam president one final question does the senator yield madam president

[01:33:18] And I would ask whether this bill takes into consideration the social cost of carbon, in that municipal waste generators generate twice, nearly three times as much carbon dioxide as gas-powered generation facilities.

[01:33:40] Senator from Eastern Fairfax. Madam President, there's nothing I love talking more about than compost. So I would say to the gentleman, first of all, I think there's a lot of assumptions built into his questions.

[01:33:56] And I'll just note, I took a tour about two years ago of a biomethanization facility in Quebec City. And what they did in Quebec City was they encouraged people in their homes to put their food waste in purple plastic bags. And the reason they did that was they could keep, the people could put their purple plastic bags in with the regular trash.

[01:34:14] And when they put it in the incinerator and using the same trucks, they didn't have that whole separate waste collection system same trucks they took it down there and went down the conveyor belt there are these things that saw the purple plastic bags activated an air cannon and segregated the food waste from the regular waste right there in the incineration facility so they didn't have to use any additional energy to get the food waste to a place to have it beneficially recycled and turned into methane so there's ways to do food waste segregation and collection while you have the users pre segregated in their homes or their businesses that might actually be able to do this in a carbon neutral way. And actually, methane is a huge problem. It's one third of the methane problem, one third of the climate change problem. And the more methane we get out of the atmosphere,

[01:34:54] the better. So it actually might be carbon positive. I thank the senator. No problem. The question is, shall Senate Bill 226 pass? All in favor of the motion? We'll record their votes. Aye. Those opposed, no. Are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted? Do any senators desire to change their vote. The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 21,

[01:35:25] noes 17. Ayes 21, noes 17. Senate Bill 226 passes. Senate Bill 400, a bill relating to admissions tax in counties, retail sales, and use tax dedicated to promotion of tourism. The chair recognizes the senator from York. Thank you, madam. Thank you, madam president. I move the bill pass and speaking to the bill senator has the floor thank you so this bill uh restores the ability of york county and james city county to collect an admissions tax they are the only two localities in the state

[01:36:01] that cannot do so and this tax is then targeted at high tourism destinations such as bush gardens and water country uh with the theory being that we can now collect uh revenue from out-of-state people and therefore given the localities an additional revenue stream where they can then use that additional revenue to reduce personal property and real estate taxes so i ask that the

[01:36:35] bill be passed the question is shall senate bill 400 pass all in favor of the motion will record their votes aye those opposed no are the senators ready to vote have all the senators voted do any senators desire to change their vote the clerk will close the roll eyes 25 nose 12 eyes 25 nose 12 senate bill 400 passes senate bill 612 a bill relating to motion picture production

[01:37:09] income tax credit sales and use tax media related exemptions the chair recognizes the senator from Washington. Thank you, Madam President. I move the bill pass and speak to the bill. Senator has the floor. This bill simply extends the sunset date of the long-standing film and motion picture tax incentive by four years. I hope the bill, I hope the bill, the will of the body bill is passed. Thank you. The question is, shall Senate Bill 612 pass? All in favor of the motion will record their votes aye. Those opposed no. Are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted? Do any senators desire to change their vote?

[01:37:49] The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 23, nose 15. Ayes 23, nose 15. Senate Bill 612 passes.

[01:38:04] Senate Bill 652, a bill to direct the State Corporation Commission's Bureau of Insurance to submit a report on data collected from property and casualty insurance providers' report. The chair recognizes the junior senator from Loudoun.

[01:38:22] Thank you, Madam President. Madam President, I move the passage of the bill, and speaking to that motion. The Senator has the floor. Thank you, Madam President. Senate Bill 652 would require the Bureau of Insurance to request and include customer satisfaction CSAT data collected by the property and casualty insurers to their annual reports so that we will have a better understanding of how insurers are serving their customers.

[01:38:46] I hope it's a will of the body to adopt this bill. Thank you, Madam President. the question is shall senate bill 652 pass all all in favor of the motion will record their votes aye those opposed no are the senators ready to vote have all the senators voted do any senators desire to change their votes the clerk will close the role eyes 37 no zero rule 361 eyes 37 no zero

[01:39:23] rule 361 senate bill 652 passes senate bill 693 a bill relating to motor vehicle insurance use of consumer credit information to establish rates prohibited unfair discrimination the chair recognizes the senator for mile of white thank you madam president i move the bill pass and speaking to that senator has the floor thank you madam president um this bill uh after it went through committee is just about a fair basis of true fairness.

[01:39:53] This bill simply states that in the issuance of motor vehicle insurance that credit scores cannot be the sole basis of denial for rates. The question is, shall Senate Bill 693 pass?

[01:40:10] All in favor of the motion will record their votes aye. Those opposed no. Are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted? Do any senators desire to change their vote? The clerk will close the roll.

[01:40:29] Ayes 33, Nose 2, Rule 36-1. Ayes 33, Nose 2, Rule 36-1. Senate Bill 693 passes. Madam President. Senator from Roanoke.

[01:40:46] Having voted on the prevailing side in which we just adopted Senate Bill 693, I ask that we reconsider that vote so everyone can be properly recorded. The question is, shall the motion by which Senate Bill 693 pass be reconsidered?

[01:41:04] All in favor of the motion will record their votes aye. Those opposed no. Are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted? Do any senators desire to change their votes? The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 37, noes 0.

[01:41:21] Ayes 37, noes 0. The motion is reconsidered. The chair recognizes the senator from Isle of Wight. Thank you, Madam President. Having previously explained the bill, I move that we pass Senate Bill 693.

[01:41:36] The question is, shall Senate Bill 693 pass? All in favor of the motion will record their votes aye, those opposed no. Are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted? Do any senators desire to change their vote?

[01:41:54] The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 36, noes 1, rule 36-1. Ayes 36, Knows 1, Rule 36-1, Senate Bill 693 passes. Uncontested calendar, Senate Bill is on second reading.

[01:42:12] The chair recognizes the senator from Eastern Fairfax. Madam President, I move that with regard to the House bills on second reading, I'm sorry, Senate Bill is on second reading on the uncontested calendar on pages 12 through 15, Senate Bill 47 through 719 be advanced, Senator Grossman, a third reading in a block, After the adoption of any amendments thereto, any senator designed to remove a bill from the block shall do so after the clerk has read the number of the bill.

[01:42:38] The question is, shall all Senate bills on second reading on the uncontested calendar on pages 12 through 15, Senate Bill 47 through Senate Bill 719 be engrossed and advanced to their third reading in the block after the adoption of any amendments thereto that any senator desiring to remove a bill from the block will do so after the clerk has read the number the bill all in favor of this motion will say aye any opposed no the ayes have it the motion is

[01:43:07] agreed to the clerk will read the number of the bills the senate will be at ease the senate will

[01:46:16] return to order the clerk will read the number of the bills senate bill 47 reported from the committee for courts of justice with the substitute and from the committee on finance and appropriations the chair recognizes the senator from chesapeake thank you madam president madam president i move the committee substitute. The question is: shall the committee substitute from the Committee for Courts of Justice be agreed to? All in favor of the motion will say aye. Any opposed, no. The ayes have it. The committee substitute is agreed to. Senate Bill 55 reported from the Committee for Courts of Justice with the substitute

[01:46:54] and from the Committee on Finance and Appropriations. The chair recognizes the senator from York. Thank you, Madam President. I move that the substitute be agreed to. The question is, shall the substitute from the Committee for Courts of Justice be agreed to? All in favor of the motion will say aye. Any opposed, no.

[01:47:12] The ayes have it. The committee substitute is agreed to. Senate bill 88, reported from the Committee on Privileges and Elections. Senate bill 149, reported from the Committee on Finance and Appropriations. Senate bill 181, reported from the Committee on Finance and Appropriations. Senate bill 285, reported the committee on finance and appropriations with a substitute the chair recognizes the senator from eastern henrico yes madam president i move the committee substitute the question is shall the substitute from the committee on finance and appropriations be agreed to all in favor of the

[01:47:52] motion we'll say aye any opposed no the ayes have it the committee substitute is agreed to Senate Bill 302, reported from the Committee on Agriculture, Conservation, and Natural Resources. Senate Bill 522, reported from the Committee on Agriculture, Conservation, and Natural Resources.

[01:48:12] Senate Bill 719, reported from the Committee on Agriculture, Conservation, and Natural Resources, with amendment. The chair recognizes the senior senator from Fairfax. Thank you, Madam President. I move that the committee amendment be agreed to. the question is shall the amendment from the committee on agriculture conservation and natural resources be agreed to all in favor of the motion will say aye any opposed no the ayes have it the committee amendment is agreed to the question is shall the bills be engrossed and advanced to their third reading all in favor of the motion will say aye any opposed no the ayes have it the

[01:48:52] The bills are now engrossed in advance to their third reading. Regular calendar, Senate bills on second reading. Senate Bill 496, a bill relating to secure storage of handguns, unattended locked vehicle penalty, reported from the Committee for Courts of Justice with a substitute, and there are five floor amendments.

[01:49:11] The chair recognizes the senior senator from Fairfax. Thank you, Madam President. Could that bill go by for the day? Without objection. Senate Bill 49, a bill relating to rules of construction and definitions appointed and qualified, reported from the Committee on Privileges and Elections.

[01:49:33] The chair recognizes the junior senator from Virginia Beach. Thank you, Madam President. Can that bill be re-referred back to the Committee on Privileges and Elections? Let's recommit. The question is, shall Senate Bill 49 be recommitted to the Committee on Privileges and Elections?

[01:49:54] All in favor of the motion will record their votes, aye. This is a voice vote. All in favor of the motion will say aye. Those opposed, no. The ayes have it. Senate Bill 49 is recommitted to the Committee on Privileges and Elections.

[01:50:13] Senate Bill 52, a bill relating to voter registration, regular periodic review of registration records, a 90-day quiet period before all primary and general elections, reported from the Committee on Privileges and Elections with a substitute.

[01:50:32] The chair recognizes the junior senator from Virginia Beach. Thank you, Madam President. I move the committee substitute be agreed to. The question is, shall the substitute from the Committee on Privileges and Elections be agreed to? All in favor of the motion will say aye.

[01:50:51] Any opposed, no. The ayes have it. The substitute is agreed to. from junior senator from Virginia Beach. Thank you Madam President. I move the bill be engrossed in advance to its third reading. The question is shall Senate Bill 52 be now engrossed in advance to its third reading. All in favor of the motion will say aye. Any opposed no. The ayes have it. Senate Bill 52 is engrossed in advance. Senate Bill 126 a bill relating to elections primary election when filings to be made, extension for incumbents' failure to file, reported from the

[01:51:30] Committee on Privileges and Elections. The chair recognizes the senator from Western Fairfax. Madam President, I move the bill be engrossed and advanced to its third reading. The question is, shall Senate Bill 126 be engrossed and advanced to its third reading? All in favor of the motion will say aye. Any opposed, no. The ayes have it. The bill is engrossed and advanced. Senate Bill 136, a bill relating to decreasing probation period reported from the Committee for Courts of Justice with amendments and

from the Committee on Finance and Appropriations. The chair recognizes the senator from Chesapeake. Thank you Madam President. Madam President I move that the committee amendments be agreed to. The

[01:52:09] question is shall the committee amendments from the Committee for Courts of Justice be agreed to? All in favor of the motion will say aye. Any opposed no. The ayes have it. The amendments are agreed to. Senator from chesapeake thank you madam president madam president i move that the bill be engrossed in advance to its third reading the question is shall the bill now be engrossed in advance to its third reading all in favor of the motion will say aye any opposed no the ayes have it senate bill 136 is engrossed and advanced senate bill 176 a bill relating to elections conduct of election

[01:52:46] ranked choice voting locally elected offices report reported from the committee on privileges and elections. The chair recognizes the senator from Western Henrico. Thank you Madam President. Madam President, I move the bill be engrossed in advance to its third reading. The question is, shall Senate bill 176 be engrossed in advance to his third reading? All in favor of the motion will say aye. Any opposed, no. The bill is engrossed and advanced. Senate bill 311, a bill to provide for the submission to the voters of a proposed amendment to section 15-A of article 1 of of the Constitution of Virginia relating to marriage

[01:53:24] between two adult persons, repeal of same-sex marriage prohibition, reported from the Committee on Privileges and Elections with a substitute. The chair recognizes the senator from Alexandria. Madam President, I move the committee substitute be agreed to. The question is, shall the substitute from the Committee on Privileges and Elections be agreed to?

[01:53:44] All in favor of that motion will say aye. Any opposed, no. The ayes have it. committee substitute is agreed to. Senator from Alexandria. Thank you, Madam President. I move the bill be engrossed and advanced to its third constitutional reading. The question is, shall Senate Bill 311 now be engrossed in advance to its third reading? All in favor of the motion will say aye. Any opposed, no. The ayes have it. The bill is engrossed and advanced. Senate Bill 350, a bill relating to elections, absentee voting, processing and counting ballots prior to the close of the

[01:54:22] polls, reported from the Committee on Privileges and Elections. The chair recognizes the senator from Prince William. Thank you, Madam President. Madam President, can this bill go by for the day?

[01:54:37] Without objection. Senate Bill 438, a bill relating to elections, absentee voting in person, available the second Sunday before all elections, reported from the Committee on Privileges and Elections with a substitute.

[01:54:53] The chair recognizes the senior senator from Henrico. Thank you, Madam President. Madam President, I move that the substitute be agreed to. The question is, shall the substitute from the Committee on Privileges and Elections be agreed to? All in favor of the motion will say aye.

[01:55:09] Any opposed, no. The ayes have it. The substitute is agreed to. Senior Senator from Henrico. Thank you, Madam President. Madam President, I move that the bill be engrossed and advanced to its third constitutional reading. The question is, shall Senate Bill 438 now be engrossed and advanced to its third reading?

[01:55:26] All in favor of the motion will say aye. Any opposed, no. The ayes have it. The bill is engrossed and advanced. Senate Bill 582, a bill relating to elections, absentee, and provisional ballots, process and

timing for rejected absentee ballot applications, returned absentee ballots, and rejected provisional ballots, reported from the Committee on Privileges and Elections.

[01:55:51] The chair recognizes the senator from Central Fairfax. Thank you, Madam President. I move that the bill be engrossed and advanced to his third reading. The question is, shall Senate Bill 582 be engrossed in advance to his third reading? All in favor of the motion will say aye. Any opposed, no.

[01:56:08] The ayes have it. The bill is engrossed in advance. Uncontested calendar, Senate Bill is on first reading. The chair recognizes the senator from Eastern Fairfax. Madam President, I move that all the Senate Bill is on first reading on the uncontested regular calendars, pages 19 through 30, Senate Bill is 165 to 765, that the rules be suspended in the first constitutional reading of the titles be dispensed with?

[01:56:35] The question is, shall the rules be suspended in the first constitutional reading of the titles of the Senate bills on the uncontested and regular calendars, pages 19 through 30, Senate Bill 165 through Senate Bill 765, be dispensed with?

[01:56:52] All in favor of the motion will record their votes aye. Those opposed, no. Are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted. Do any Senators desire to change their vote? The Clerk will close the roll.

[01:57:10] Ayes 38, noes 0. Ayes 38, noes 0. The reading of the titles is dispensed with. Senator from Eastern Fairfax. Madam President, I move that all those bills go by for the day. The question is, shall the Senate bills on the uncontested and regular calendars now on their second reading be passed by for the day?

[01:57:31] All in favor of the motion, we'll say aye. Any opposed, no. The ayes have it, the bills will go by for the day. Regular calendar, Senate Joint Resolutions on second reading, Senate Joint Resolution 60, confirming appointments by the governor of certain persons communicated to the General Assembly January 21st, 2026, reported from the Committee on Privileges and Elections.

[01:57:59] The chair recognizes the junior senator from Virginia Beach. Thank you, Madam President. I move to SJ 60, be engrossed in advance to this third reading. The question is: Shall SJR 60 be engrossed in advance to his third reading?

[01:58:17] All in favor of the motion will say aye. Any opposed, no. The ayes have it. The bill is engrossed and advanced. Senate Joint Resolution 61: Confirming appointments by the Governor of certain persons communicated to the General Assembly January 23, 2026, reported from the Committee on Privileges and Elections.

[01:58:37] The junior senator from Virginia Beach. Thank you, Madam President. move that sjr 61 be engrossed in advance to his third reading the question is shall sjr 61 be engrossed in advance to his third reading all in favor of the motion will say aye any opposed no the ayes have it sjr 61 is engrossed and advanced supplemental calendar number one regular calendar house bills on second reading house bill 612 a bill to provide for the submission to the voters a proposed amendment to section 15-A of article 1 of the Constitution of

[01:59:14] Virginia relating to marriage between two adult persons, repeal of same-sex marriage prohibition. House Bill 781, a bill to provide for the submission to the voters of a proposed amendment to the Constitution of Virginia by adding an article 1, a section numbered 11-A relating to fundamental right

to reproductive freedom. House Bill 963, a bill to provide for the submission to the voters of a proposed amendment to section one of article two of the Constitution of Virginia relating to qualification of voters right to vote

[01:59:49] persons not entitled to vote the chair recognizes the senator from Eastern Fairfax madam clerk does that complete today's calendar yes sir is there any other business to come before the Senate the chair recognize the chair recognizes the senator from Portsmouth the clerk will report any announcements

[02:00:25] on the desk. Friday, January 30th, 2026. The Committee on Education and Health will meet immediately upon adjournment at the chair's desk. The Finance and Appropriations Subcommittee on General Government will meet one hour and 15 minutes after adjournment in the Senate Finance and Appropriations Room, 13th floor, GAB. Monday, February 2nd, 2026. The Committee for Courts of Justice will meet at 8 o'clock a.m. in Senate Room A, GAB.

[02:00:56] The Committee on Local Government will meet at 8.30 a.m. in Senate Room B, GAB. The Education and Health Subcommittee on Higher Education will meet at 8.30 a.m. in Senate Room C, GAB. The Democratic Caucus will meet at 11.15 a.m. in Senate Room 1 of the Capitol.

[02:01:14] The Republican Caucus will meet at 11.30 a.m. in Senate Room 2 of the Capitol. Weekend Weather Report. Winter Storm Watch. Heavy snow possible from late tonight through Sunday afternoon for portions of central, east central, eastern and south central Virginia. Total accumulations between one to four inches, plan on slippery road conditions and difficult travel. Many secondary and neighborhood roads remain covered with snow and ice from last weekend's storm. And there is an extreme cold watch continuing through Sunday with wind chills as low as

[02:01:50] minus five degrees possible saturday's high is the low to mid 20s and sunday's high is around 30 degrees please travel safely and friendly this weekend the chair recognizes the senator from portsmouth thank you madam president madam president i move that the senate do now adjourn until 12 noon on monday the question is shall the senate adjourn until 12 noon monday all in favor of the motion will say aye. Any opposed, no. The ayes have it. The motion is agreed to. The Senate stands

[02:02:26] adjourned until 12 noon, Monday. Senate chamber. This is the Senate of Virginia. Richmond,

[02:04:40] Virginia. Senate chamber. Be sure to stay connected with live sessions, catch up on past

[02:06:46] meetings, and explore our full archives anytime on the Senate of Virginia's YouTube channel. Music